

Group Project Assessment

The group project is an integral part of the course and is designed to help students apply the theoretical and empirical concepts discussed during the lectures to a concrete, data-driven analysis of the digital economy. You are expected to work in groups and to select a topic that is related to the themes covered in the syllabus, such as digital infrastructure, platforms and standards, productivity and digitalisation, intangible assets, artificial intelligence, data and digital policy, or competition and labour market dynamics in the digital economy.

To be clear, while it is important that the topic you choose is related to what we cover in class, we are keen to leave you with the ability to choose something you are interested in. There is therefore some leeway on the topic, although this should not be excessive. It is important that the topic you choose is related to digital technologies and the underlying economic mechanisms, so that it falls within our expertise and we can assist you as much as possible.

During the semester there will be two Intermediate Report sessions on group presentations, scheduled for the 9th and the 13th of March. These sessions are an essential part of the learning process. Their purpose is not evaluation, but guidance and collective learning. You should approach them in a calm and constructive spirit, without anxiety about performance or grades.

During each Intermediate Report session, groups will briefly present their project idea to the class. Each group will have maximum five minutes to present, followed by feedback from the instructor. On each day there will be seven to eight groups presenting, with approximately twelve minutes allocated to each group overall.

In their presentation, groups are expected to clearly explain the main topic they would like to focus on and what data they intend to use for their analysis. This includes explaining where the data come from, why they are relevant for the research question, and whether they are representative of the phenomenon being studied. The instructor will then share feedback on whether the topic is relevant, the data is appropriate and the overall feasibility of the project, so that students will have the opportunity to correct if necessary.

Groups should also explain the analytical approach they plan to adopt. This does not require advanced technical detail, but students should show that they have a clear idea of how they intend to use the data to address their research question. This includes explaining what variables will be analysed, what kind of relationships they are interested in exploring, and how the analysis helps in understanding the economic mechanisms at play in the digital economy.

A central objective of the Intermediate Reports is to assess the feasibility of the project. Feedback will therefore focus exclusively on whether the research question is well defined, whether the data are suitable and accessible, and whether the proposed analysis can realistically be completed within the time and constraints of the course. The feedback will not concern whether the topic is interesting, original, or aesthetically appealing. The only criterion at this stage is whether the project is feasible and coherent with the course objectives. Once again, no assessment will take place during the Intermediate Report presentations. These two sessions are entirely for your benefit so please come with as much a detailed project as possible so that the feedback you will receive will be useful for you.

The final project presentations will take place on the 24th and 27th of April, and on the 4th of May. These sessions will constitute the formal assessment of the group work and will require students to present the completed analysis and main results of their project.

For completeness, we also report below the instruction about group assessments from the syllabus:

Group project and will provide students with the opportunity to apply the knowledge and skills acquired during the module to a topic of their choosing that interests them. Students will present an applied, data-driven exploration of the digital transformation in the economy. This can be based on any source of data or case study. A range of relevant topics and sources will be presented in the first class of the module. While students are encouraged to come up with their own specific topic for this project, possible topics can be:

1. A focus on digital technologies in a specific country and industry.
2. A focus on a specific digital technology (AI, internet, robotization, digital trade) and its diffusion across sectors and countries.
3. A case study of business models that have undergone significant changes through internet and networks.
4. A policy challenge that has emerged through digitalization. E.g. the value of data, market concentration, technology-related unemployment, growing inequalities.

In carrying out this project students will be expected to:

1. Present the topic the students have chosen and its relevance (**Making judgements and Communication skills**).
2. Discuss the key concepts that are relevant to study the topic (**Applying knowledge and understanding**).
3. Discuss the key issue and implications around the chosen topic (**Applying knowledge and understanding and Learning skills**).
4. Show how the data they chose shed light on the issues around their topic (**Learning skills**).
5. Present in a clear and concise manner the main results of their analysis (**Learning skills and Communication skills**).